Stablecoin Insider

Q3 | September 2026

MONEY MOVES EAST

The Stablecoin Corridors in Asia in 2026

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CAPITAL LAYER MOVANTIS REAP by PAYWARD

STABO Triple-A.

Executive Summary

In the twelve months to September 2026, **Hong Kong** granted its first two stablecoin issuer licences, **Japan** put a trust-bank yen stablecoin into live issuance, **Taiwan** passed a dedicated virtual asset statute, and **Singapore** published the draft legislation that will write its 2023 stablecoin framework into law. No other region has shipped this many named-issuer regimes in a single year.

The structural pull behind that regulatory sprint is enormous. APAC's outbound cross-border payments reached **$13.5 trillion** in 2025 and are projected to grow to $24 trillion by 2035, lifting the region's share of global outbound flows from **31% to 36%** (Source: FXC Intelligence). India and the Philippines remain two of the world's largest remittance recipients. And Asia already originates roughly **60% of the world's genuine stablecoin payment volume**, driven almost entirely by Singapore, Hong Kong, and Japan (Source: McKinsey & Company). **What makes APAC distinct is that regulated stablecoins are arriving as licensed financial infrastructure rather than as workarounds.**

What the report covers & the key players

CAPITAL LAYER

The Taipei-based provider of stablecoin infrastructure for the global AI supply chain, on why Asia's largest export corridor gets built through banks or not at all, the receiving end of AI-era payments, and the operational reality of Taiwan's new Virtual Asset Service Act.

MOVANTIS

The regulated financial infrastructure platform for cross-border value movement across the Americas and beyond, combining payments, remittances, FX & Liquidity, wallet infrastructure, Card Issuing and Processing, stablecoin settlement through one integration, Circle Payments Network member, hybrid fiat-&-stablecoin routing into APAC.

REAP by PAYWARD

The global stablecoin-native financial infrastructure platform that started in Hong Kong being acquired by Kraken's parent for up to $600 million, on corporate spend, the two adoption curves of crypto-native and traditional businesses, and agentic payments.

STABO

The Hong Kong TCSP-structured treasury platform, on B2B collections, custody structures, and the compliance risks that replace chargebacks when merchants accept stablecoins.

Triple-A.

The payment institution licensed in the United States, Europe, and Singapore, on merchant acceptance, stablecoin payouts, treasury flows, and corridor growth out of APAC to Europe and MENA.

Why APAC

The three demand engines, the fragmented FX and banking layer, and why APAC adoption is necessity-driven.

The Regulatory Map

Singapore's MAS Single-Currency Stablecoin Framework, Hong Kong's Stablecoins Ordinance, the HKMA, Japan's Payment Services Act and the three-lane yen stack, Taiwan's Virtual Asset Service Act, the watchlist covering South Korea, Australia, and UAE–APAC flows.

The Numbers

Market sizing, settlement volume across three measures, corridor breakdown by flow type, adoption segmentation, and the funding and M&A snapshot.

Who Is Building APAC's Stablecoin Economy

Trade settlement and the bank connectivity layer, corporate payments through stablecoin-funded cards, merchant acceptance, enterprise treasury from collections to capital deployment, and remittances on the hybrid-rail model.

Corridor Analysis

Intra-APAC (SG ↔ HK ↔ JP and TW ↔ JP ↔ KR), APAC–US, APAC–Middle East, and the high-volume remittance lanes from the US and Gulf into the Philippines, India, and Indonesia.

Key Sectors in APAC Most in Need of Stablecoins

Supply chains and trade settlement, remittances, cross-border e-commerce and digital commerce, and corporate treasury and FX optimisation.

Money That Works

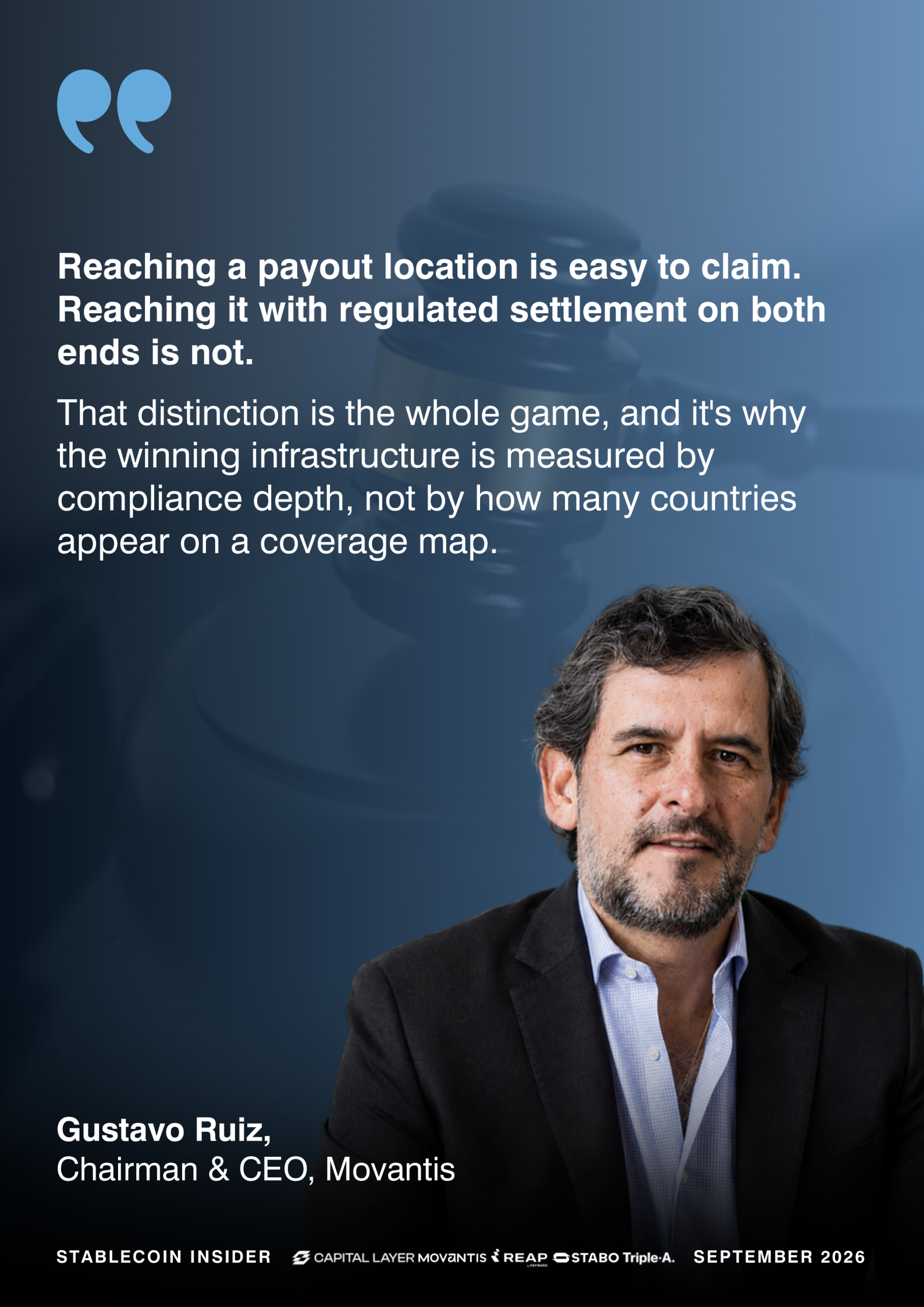
Legacy correspondent banking versus stablecoin rails, what changes on the balance sheet, what does not change, practical entry points by jurisdiction, and the routing principle.

Outlook 2026–2027

Which licences clear next, where multi-currency settlement consolidates, the regulatory arbitrage that closes, and the forward view on agentic payments and B2B automation.

Reaching a payout location is easy to claim. Reaching it with regulated settlement on both ends is not.

That distinction is the whole game, and it's why the winning infrastructure is measured by compliance depth, not by how many countries appear on a coverage map.



Gustavo Ruiz,
Chairman & CEO, Movantis

The Act takes effect in the first quarter of 2027, and existing operators have until 2029 to be licensed. That is the window.

The settlement layer for Asia's largest export corridor gets decided inside it, and it gets decided inside banks. Licensing opens the door.

Whether a bank can receive, screen, and account for a stablecoin payment inside systems its auditors already trust is what decides who walks through it.

Justin Wang,
CEO, Capital Layer

We started in Asia because the region gave us the right conditions to build. Asia's economic diversity, spanning multiple socioeconomic classes and stages of development, let us design financial products suited to very different needs, and the region's technology infrastructure gave us a strong foundation to build on. With more than 70 million MSMEs across the region, and Asia-Pacific already the world's largest crypto market at $2.36 trillion in transactions, this is where stablecoin infrastructure was always going to take shape first.

Card issuing is where that infrastructure found its first real-world use case at scale. Before stablecoins were being discussed as infrastructure, card issuing was already proving the model, powering B2B payments that needed to move fast and across borders without the friction of traditional rails. That gave stablecoins their earliest validation, not as a speculative asset, but as the plumbing behind real commercial transactions.

Agentic payments are really the next frontier. When agents begin initiating and coordinating transactions at scale, stablecoin rails will likely become the default infrastructure layer for those new payment flows and eventually the architecture of global financial systems.

Daren Guo,
Co-Founder, Reap

APAC has moved beyond simply being a high-adoption digital currency market. We are now seeing stablecoins used as real cross-border payment infrastructure.

Triple-A's APAC-origin flows to Europe grew 205% in 2025, while flows from APAC to MENA rose 604%, with strong growth continuing across key corridors in 2026.

This points to a broader shift: businesses are increasingly choosing stablecoins where traditional cross-border payments create the most friction.

Eric Barbier,
CEO, Triple-A

STABO is addressing one of the most important barriers to digital asset adoption: transforming on-chain instruments into trusted infrastructure for real business payments.

As a professional and valued partner, STABO pairs strong execution with a disciplined approach to regulatory compliance and banking infrastructure built into its foundation.

This allows STABO to be uniquely positioned as a key bridge to the global financial system.

Zihang Ding,
Senior Head of Operations, Green Link Digital Bank

Our Partners

CAPITAL LAYER

CAPITAL LAYER
Asia's digital asset orchestration layer, coordinating stablecoin settlement, custody and compliance between the region's banks, enterprises and infrastructure providers.

MOVANTIS

MOVANTIS
Regulated financial infrastructure for cross-border value movement across the Americas and beyond, combining payments, remittances, FX, wallet infrastructure, card issuing, and stablecoin settlement through one integration. $63B+ in annual volume. Circle Payments Network member.

REAP by PAYWARD

REAP
Hong Kong-based payments infrastructure that lets businesses spend, send and settle in stablecoins through cards and API-driven money movement.

STABO

STABO
A Hong Kong-licensed clearing layer that connects banking rails and stablecoin liquidity so businesses can accept, convert and settle fiat and stablecoins in one flow.

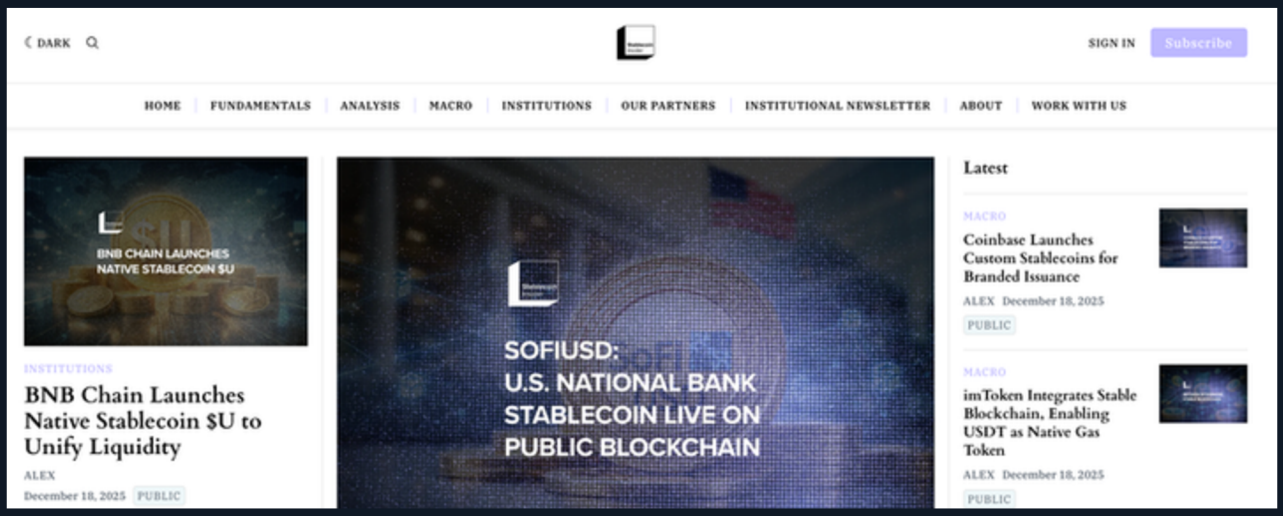
Triple-A.

TRIPLE-A
A global payment institution licensed across Singapore, Europe and the United States, enabling businesses to accept and make stablecoin payments with settlement in local currencies.

About Stablecoin Insider

Stablecoin Insider is the leading source for news, data, and expert insights on stablecoins and the future of blockchain-based finance. As global interest in stable digital currencies accelerates, we deliver in-depth, independent reporting on the technologies, platforms, policies, and real-world use cases driving stablecoin adoption worldwide.

Stablecoin Insider works closely with companies across the stablecoin and digital payments stack to help them increase visibility, credibility, and discoverability. On a journey to be the go-to knowledge hub for professionals in the stablecoin space serving the space through articles, reports, interviews, collaborations, and events.



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stablecoininsider.org
partnerships@stablecoininsider.com

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